Grade 4 ELA

Reading Foundations and Fluency

Common Core-aligned question bank • RF.4.3–RF.4.4

150 Multiple-Choice Questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Includes an answer key. Answer choices are independently randomized to avoid a predictable answer pattern.

Topics include multisyllabic word decoding, syllable patterns, prefixes, suffixes, roots, spelling patterns, pronunciation, context clues, and fluent oral reading.

Easy Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

1. Which word has three syllables?

A. jump
B. train
C. animal
D. bright

2. Which word has a prefix meaning “not”?

A. unfair
B. helpful
C. careful
D. teacher

3. What does the suffix “-less” mean in “fearless”?

A. full of
B. without
C. one who
D. again

4. Which word contains the root “help”?

A. helmet
B. helicopter
C. helpful
D. hello

5. Which word is divided into syllables correctly?

A. na-pk-in
B. nap-kin
C. napk-in
D. n-apkin

6. Which word has a long a sound spelled with “ai”?

A. ten
B. train
C. trap
D. tap

7. Which word has a long o sound spelled with “oa”?

A. cost
B. coast
C. cot
D. cut

8. Which word has a vowel team?

A. sit
B. hot
C. team
D. tap

9. Which word has a silent letter?

A. nest
B. knee
C. name
D. near

10. Which word contains the consonant-le syllable pattern?

A. candle
B. open
C. sun
D. cat

11. What does the prefix “re-” mean in “rewrite”?

A. under
B. again
C. not
D. before

12. What does “-ful” mean in “joyful”?

A. without
B. small
C. before
D. full of

13. Which word means “to look at something again”?

A. review
B. dislike
C. misread
D. preview

14. Which word has the same base word as “farmer”?

A. form
B. farm
C. frame
D. firm

15. Which word is a compound word?

A. lighten
B. sunny
C. sunlight
D. sunrise

16. Which word has two syllables?

A. picnic
B. school
C. bright
D. jump

17. Which word has one syllable?

A. rabbit
B. window
C. open
D. thought

18. Which word begins with a consonant blend?

A. ship
B. frog
C. thin
D. fish

19. Which word begins with a consonant digraph?

A. chair
B. grin
C. stop
D. clap

20. Which word has the /j/ sound spelled with “dge”?

A. badge
B. bridge
C. judge
D. All three

21. Which word has a soft c sound?

A. cup
B. clap
C. city
D. coat

22. Which word has a soft g sound?

A. goat
B. gum
C. giant
D. glad

23. Which word has the same ending sound as “wish”?

A. wide
B. win
C. will
D. brush

24. Which word has a prefix that means “before”?

A. redo
B. unkind
C. preview
D. misplace

25. Which word has a suffix that means “a person who”?

A. artful
B. artless
C. artistically
D. artist

26. Which word is spelled correctly?

A. carefuly
B. carefulley
C. carefullly
D. carefully

27. Which word is spelled correctly?

A. happyness
B. happynesss
C. happiness
D. happines

28. Which word is the base word in “disagreement”?

A. disagreeing
B. dis
C. agree
D. ment

29. Which word has the same root as “sign”?

A. silence
B. single
C. singer
D. signal

30. Which word has a long e sound spelled “ee”?

A. great
B. green
C. get
D. grin

31. Which word has a short i sound?

A. stick
B. time
C. shine
D. slide

32. Which word has an r-controlled vowel?

A. stay
B. stem
C. storm
D. step

33. Which word has a diphthong sound spelled “oi”?

A. point
B. pane
C. pin
D. paint

34. Which word contains “igh” for the long i sound?

A. brim
B. brick
C. bright
D. bring

35. Which word is divided correctly at a syllable boundary?

A. r-abbit
B. ra-bb-it
C. rabb-it
D. rab-bit

36. Which word has a prefix meaning “wrongly”?

A. misjudge
B. preview
C. unhappy
D. rewrite

37. Which word means “able to be read”?

A. readily
B. reader
C. readable
D. reading

38. Which word means “not active”?

A. activity
B. activate
C. inactive
D. reactive

39. Which word has a suffix that changes a verb into a noun?

A. moving
B. movement
C. movable
D. moved

40. Which word has a silent w?

A. write
B. win
C. wet
D. wag

41. Which word has a silent b?

A. thumb
B. number
C. bamboo
D. bubble

42. Which word has the /f/ sound spelled “ph”?

A. fast
B. fine
C. phone
D. fan

43. Which word has a prefix meaning “under”?

A. submarine
B. disagree
C. rebuild
D. preview

44. Which word has a suffix meaning “more than one”?

A. booklet
B. bookcase
C. bookish
D. books

45. Which word has a closed syllable with a short vowel?

A. rabbit
B. paper
C. robot
D. music

46. Which word has an open syllable ending in a vowel sound?

A. napkin
B. sunset
C. basket
D. robot

47. Which word has a vowel-consonant-e pattern?

A. pet
B. sit
C. invite
D. stop

48. Which word has a vowel team that makes a long a sound?

A. dad
B. day
C. dig
D. dark

49. Which word has a long u sound?

A. cut
B. cube
C. cub
D. cup

50. Which word is most likely to be read smoothly in a fluent sentence?

A. uncharacteristically
B. familiarization
C. familiar
D. intercontinental

Medium Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

51. What does the prefix “inter-” mean in “international”?

A. under
B. again
C. between or among
D. not

52. What does the prefix “pre-” mean in “preheat”?

A. across
B. after
C. before
D. not

53. What does the suffix “-ment” do in “enjoyment”?

A. means not
B. forms a noun
C. forms a plural verb
D. means before

54. What does the suffix “-able” mean in “portable”?

A. full of
B. without
C. able to be
D. one who

55. Which word contains a root meaning “write”?

A. transport
B. describe
C. spectator
D. audible

56. Which word contains a root meaning “look”?

A. dictate
B. submerge
C. inspect
D. portable

57. Which word contains a root meaning “carry”?

A. transport
B. telephone
C. predict
D. spectacle

58. Which word is divided into syllables correctly?

A. inf-orm-ation
B. in-for-ma-tion
C. infor-mat-ion
D. i-nfor-ma-tion

59. Which word has four syllables?

A. garden
B. celebration
C. fantastic
D. remember

60. Which word has three syllables?

A. ship
B. remembering
C. computer
D. window

61. Which word uses the “tion” ending to form a noun?

A. invent
B. inventive
C. invention
D. inventor

62. Which word uses a prefix to mean “do again”?

A. reconsider
B. preview
C. disappear
D. unusual

63. What does “disapprove” mean?

A. approve again
B. approve before
C. approve under
D. not approve

64. What does “unpredictable” most nearly mean?

A. predicted again
B. able to be predicted
C. predicted before
D. not able to be predicted

65. Which word has a root related to sound?

A. visible
B. audience
C. manuscript
D. transport

66. Which word has a root related to seeing?

A. portable
B. audible
C. manual
D. visible

67. Which word has a root meaning “hand”?

A. aquatic
B. manual
C. telephone
D. spectator

68. Which word has a root meaning “water”?

A. aquarium
B. predict
C. scribble
D. manual

69. Which word is most likely to have a long vowel in its first syllable?

A. hotel
B. sunset
C. rabbit
D. napkin

70. Which word has a consonant-le final syllable?

A. music
B. open
C. paper
D. purple

71. Which word contains a vowel-r syllable?

A. market
B. hotel
C. cabin
D. music

72. Which word contains a vowel team with a different sound from “bread”?

A. beach
B. thread
C. head
D. spread

73. Which word has the same vowel sound as “cloud”?

A. could
B. blood
C. group
D. shout

74. Which word has the same vowel sound as “coin”?

A. chew
B. coat
C. choice
D. chain

75. Which word has the same vowel sound as “boy”?

A. bee
B. buy
C. enjoy
D. bay

76. Which word contains a three-letter consonant blend?

A. think
B. splash
C. chair
D. ship

77. Which word contains a consonant digraph at the end?

A. mist
B. must
C. match
D. mask

78. Which word has a soft c sound because c comes before e?

A. century
B. crash
C. cotton
D. cactus

79. Which word has a soft g sound because g comes before e?

A. garden
B. gum
C. gentle
D. goose

80. Which word is a homograph whose pronunciation can change with meaning?

A. basket
B. rabbit
C. window
D. record

81. Which strategy helps decode an unfamiliar multisyllabic word?

A. Read only the last letter
B. Guess without looking at parts
C. Skip every vowel
D. Break it into syllables and read each part

82. When a word has a familiar prefix and base word, what can help you understand it?

A. Replace the word with a random word
B. Ignore the prefix
C. Use the prefix meaning and base-word meaning
D. Read only the suffix

83. Which word means “to see beforehand”?

A. viewpoint
B. review
C. interview
D. preview

84. Which word means “a person who studies the earth”?

A. artist
B. musician
C. biologist
D. geologist

85. Which word contains the suffix “-ist,” often meaning a person associated with an activity?

A. scientific
B. scientist
C. science
D. scientifically

86. Which word contains a suffix meaning “full of”?

A. hoping
B. hopeful
C. hopeless
D. hoped

87. Which word contains a suffix meaning “without”?

A. painfully
B. painless
C. painkiller
D. painful

88. Which word has a base word that changes spelling when adding a suffix?

A. happiness
B. slowly
C. kindness
D. helpful

89. Which word is spelled correctly with a suffix added to “hope”?

A. hopefulless
B. hope-less
C. hopeless
D. hopless

90. Which word is spelled correctly when changing “carry” to a past-tense verb?

A. carrid
B. carrys
C. carried
D. carryed

91. Which word has the same base as “musician”?

A. muscle
B. music
C. mustard
D. museum

92. Which word has the same base as “national”?

A. native
B. nation
C. notion
D. natural

93. Which word contains a prefix meaning “against”?

A. preview
B. rebuild
C. antifreeze
D. subway

94. Which word contains a prefix meaning “one”?

A. bicycle
B. tricycle
C. multicolor
D. unicycle

95. Which word has a prefix meaning “many”?

A. monologue
B. unicorn
C. multicolor
D. bicycle

96. Which word has a suffix that means “in a certain way”?

A. slowest
B. slowly
C. slowness
D. slower

97. Which word is best decoded by recognizing the base word “struct,” meaning build?

A. All three
B. destruction
C. construction
D. instruction

98. Which word has a root related to “say” or “speak”?

A. dictate
B. aquatic
C. manual
D. spectacle

99. Which word contains the root “bio,” meaning life?

A. telephone
B. biology
C. geometry
D. geology

100. Which word has the root “phon,” meaning sound?

A. physical
B. phonics
C. photograph
D. phrase

Hard Questions

Select the best answer for each question.

101. In “The scientist observed microscopic organisms,” what does “micro-” suggest?

A. sound
B. life
C. small
D. large

102. What does “chronological” suggest about the order of events?

A. arranged by size
B. arranged by location
C. arranged by color
D. arranged by time

103. Which word contains a root meaning “life” and a suffix meaning “study of”?

A. telephone
B. geography
C. manuscript
D. biology

104. Which word is most likely to mean “able to be seen”?

A. predictable
B. audible
C. visible
D. portable

105. What does “reconstruct” most nearly mean?

A. build under
B. build wrongly
C. build again
D. build before

106. What does “invisible” mean?

A. seen beforehand
B. able to be seen
C. not able to be seen
D. seen again

107. Which word contains a prefix meaning “across”?

A. preview
B. transport
C. unhappy
D. misread

108. Which word has a root meaning “earth”?

A. manual
B. phonics
C. geology
D. biology

109. Which word contains a root meaning “many”?

A. bicycle
B. unicycle
C. monorail
D. multilingual

110. Which word means “a person who writes books”?

A. audience
B. author
C. audible
D. authority

111. Which strategy is best when a multisyllabic word is unfamiliar but has known parts?

A. Identify prefixes, roots, suffixes, and syllables
B. Read every syllable as a separate word
C. Guess from the first letter only
D. Ignore the context

112. A reader misreads “comfortable” as “com-for-table.” What would help most?

A. Ignore the word every time
B. Change the sentence
C. Practice its common pronunciation and syllable pattern
D. Read only the first syllable

113. Which word has a different stress pattern from the others?

A. photographer
B. photographic
C. All have identical stress
D. photograph

114. Which word is a noun formed with the suffix “-ity”?

A. actively
B. activity
C. active
D. activate

115. Which word is an adjective formed from a noun with “-ous”?

A. dangerously
B. danger
C. dangerous
D. endanger

116. Which word contains a prefix meaning “not” and a suffix meaning “state of”?

A. rekindle
B. unkindness
C. kindly
D. kindness

117. What does “misinterpret” mean?

A. understand again
B. understand incorrectly
C. understand completely
D. understand beforehand

118. Which word contains the root “rupt,” meaning break?

A. interrupt
B. manuscript
C. transport
D. spectator

119. Which word contains the root “struct,” meaning build?

A. spectacle
B. audible
C. structure
D. aquarium

120. Which word contains the root “ject,” meaning throw?

A. predict
B. protect
C. produce
D. project

121. Which word contains the root “port,” meaning carry?

A. portrait
B. portion
C. portable
D. portal

122. Which word contains the root “scrib” or “script,” meaning write?

A. manual
B. aquatic
C. description
D. spectator

123. Which word contains the root “spect,” meaning look?

A. special
B. speech
C. spectacle
D. species

124. Which word contains the root “dict,” meaning say?

A. biology
B. portable
C. predict
D. inspect

125. Which word has a suffix that changes an adjective into an adverb?

A. careful
B. carefully
C. carefulness
D. care

126. Which word has a suffix that changes a verb into a person noun?

A. runny
B. runnable
C. running
D. runner

127. Which word uses a prefix and suffix around a base word?

A. helper
B. helping
C. help
D. unhelpful

128. Which word is best decoded by noticing that “-ology” means “study of”?

A. meteor
B. meteorology
C. meter
D. metronome

129. Which word has the same vowel sound as “steam”?

A. said
B. dream
C. great
D. bread

130. Which word has the same vowel sound as “rough”?

A. though
B. thought
C. tough
D. through

131. Which word has the same vowel sound as “height”?

A. heat
B. flight
C. heart
D. hit

132. Which word has the same vowel sound as “author”?

A. caught
B. laughter
C. All three
D. daughter

133. Which word contains a syllable with a schwa sound in its unstressed syllable?

A. about
B. cat
C. fish
D. sun

134. Why is recognizing syllable stress helpful when reading aloud?

A. It tells the reader to skip punctuation
B. It helps make pronunciation sound natural and clear
C. It removes the need to understand words
D. It makes every vowel long

135. Which reading behavior best demonstrates fluency?

A. Reading as fast as possible with many errors
B. Guessing words without checking
C. Reading accurately, at an appropriate pace, with expression
D. Saying every word in the same flat tone

136. If a reader repeatedly pauses in the middle of familiar phrases, what should they practice?

A. Speeding up without accuracy
B. Reading meaningful phrases smoothly
C. Skipping punctuation
D. Reading each letter separately

137. How should a reader's voice usually change at the end of a question read aloud?

A. Always whisper
B. Always shout
C. Stop before the final word
D. Use expression that signals a question

138. Which punctuation cue usually signals a longer pause than a comma?

A. apostrophe
B. quotation mark
C. period
D. hyphen

139. Which is the best way to improve accuracy when a word is misread?

A. Ignore the error
B. Replace it with any familiar word
C. Reread the word, decode it, and read the sentence again
D. Read faster

140. Which practice best supports fluent reading of a passage?

A. Skipping difficult sentences
B. Reading once while distracted
C. Memorizing only the title
D. Repeated reading with feedback

141. What should a fluent reader do when encountering an unfamiliar word in a passage?

A. Guess randomly and continue
B. Skip the entire paragraph
C. Use decoding strategies and context, then reread the sentence
D. Read only the first letter

142. Which sentence is best read with excitement?

A. “We won the championship!” Maya cheered.
B. The paper is on the desk.
C. The plant needs water.
D. The library closes at five.

143. Which sentence should be read with a pause at the comma?

A. The sun is bright.
B. After lunch, we returned to class.
C. Birds can fly.
D. The bell rang.

144. What does it mean to read with appropriate rate?

A. Read every word slowly no matter what
B. Pause after every letter
C. Read as quickly as possible
D. Read at a pace that supports understanding

145. Which action helps a reader check whether a decoded word makes sense?

A. Look only at the word length
B. Skip all surrounding words
C. Reread the sentence and use context
D. Ignore the sentence meaning

146. Which word is most likely to require careful syllable-by-syllable decoding?

A. jump
B. responsibility
C. fish
D. cat

147. Which word has a prefix that changes the meaning of “appear” to its opposite?

A. appearing
B. appearance
C. reappear
D. disappear

148. Which word contains a root related to “light”?

A. manual
B. transport
C. illuminate
D. audible

149. Which word means “to make something shorter or smaller”?

A. introduce
B. produce
C. reduce
D. deduce

150. Which approach best combines decoding and comprehension?

A. Read the word accurately, then check its meaning in the sentence
B. Focus on speed instead of accuracy
C. Guess from the picture only
D. Sound out the word without considering meaning

Answer Key

Answers match the shuffled options in the question sections.

Easy

1. C 2. A 3. B 4. C 5. B
6. B 7. B 8. C 9. B 10. A
11. B 12. D 13. A 14. B 15. C
16. A 17. D 18. B 19. A 20. D
21. C 22. C 23. D 24. C 25. D
26. D 27. C 28. C 29. D 30. B
31. A 32. C 33. A 34. C 35. D
36. A 37. C 38. C 39. B 40. A
41. A 42. C 43. A 44. D 45. A
46. D 47. C 48. B 49. B 50. C

Medium

51. C 52. C 53. B 54. C 55. B
56. C 57. A 58. B 59. B 60. C
61. C 62. A 63. D 64. D 65. B
66. D 67. B 68. A 69. A 70. D
71. A 72. A 73. D 74. C 75. C
76. B 77. C 78. A 79. C 80. D
81. D 82. C 83. D 84. D 85. B
86. B 87. B 88. A 89. C 90. C
91. B 92. B 93. C 94. D 95. C
96. B 97. A 98. A 99. B 100. B

Hard

101. C 102. D 103. D 104. C 105. C
106. C 107. B 108. C 109. D 110. B
111. A 112. C 113. C 114. B 115. C
116. B 117. B 118. A 119. C 120. D
121. C 122. C 123. C 124. C 125. B
126. D 127. D 128. B 129. B 130. C
131. B 132. C 133. A 134. B 135. C
136. B 137. D 138. C 139. C 140. D
141. C 142. A 143. B 144. D 145. C
146. B 147. D 148. C 149. C 150. A